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WORLD POTATO CONGRESS

THE GOOD POTATO INITIATIVE

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Being a processor in the Potato Value Chain, Sereni's competitive edge is supply of consistent quality potato products to its customers year round. The potato crop was introduced inEast Africa in the early 1880s and since then it has gained its popularity. [1]For instance in Kenya, it is the second most important food after maize according to the National Potato Council of Kenya. However, snags to high production of the Irish Potato in Kenya exist attributable to:

1. Traditional Land Preparation Methods
2. Use of recycled seeds
3. Inappropriate/ incorrect use of agrochemicals
4. Inadequate and untimely information provision to farmers e.g. weather information.

Sereni main potato products are fresh cut potatoes, crisps and the frozen potato product which is in its final stage of
development. The most preferred potato variety is the Markies, locally propagated in Kenya by Agrico Kenya.

In a bid to reduce the above mentioned challenges which are a high risk to our production efficiency, Sereni through its Good Potato Initiative trains small holder farmers on Good Agricultural Practices and Climate Smart Agricultural Practices. The desired impact of the program are as summarized below:

a. Popularizing Regenerative Agriculture
b. Increasing the crop productivity in terms of volumes and quality
c. Reducing post harvest losses
d. Improved standards of living for our small holder farmers through the economical benefits associated with our contract farming model after successful completion of training
e. Poverty Eradication
f. Economical gains by various stakeholders along the value chains due to strengthened linkages.
g. Job Creation at farm levels and company levels
h. Women and youth empowerment by encouraging them to onboard the training program and later transfer to commercial farming for us.
i. Increased food security thus reducing hunger in the country .

Good Potato Initiative Program Registered Impact

Details	Unit of measure	Total
Small Holder Farmers Trained	Pax	3,479
Small Holder Farmers Contracted	Pax	2,087
Ware Potato bought back	Kg	2,347,000
Service providers linked to shfs	Pax	6

The future of the Irish potato is bright in Kenya and East Africa Region. Currently there are efforts to regularize the sector majorly through government legislations, government lobbying, research and collaboration of players within the value chain. **[2]Kenya alone has capacity to produce over 10 million metric tones of ware potato from the current 2 million metric tones per annum.**

1 https://npck.org/potato-production-growth-in-africa
2 https://www.agroberichtenbuitenland.nl/

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